

Mariah Blake

Career Objective

21 years in DevOps/Infrastructure, most of it spent on systems other teams depend on. Comfortable leading technical decisions, pushing back on scope when it matters, and carrying a pager for what I build. Primary tools: Redis and Ansible.

Academic History

Bachelor, Biology

Eastbrook State University | 2000 — 2004

Dean's List (2 years)

Relevant coursework: Genetics, Biostatistics, Cell Biology, Bioinformatics

Professional Experience

Staff DevOps Engineer

Lumen Works | 2019-04 — Present

- Introduced infrastructure-as-code with Nginx, eliminating manual provisioning entirely.
- Introduced secret rotation and least-privilege IAM across 2 accounts.
- Built CI/CD pipelines with Jenkins, bringing mean time to deploy under 12 minutes.
- Hardened Nginx environments ahead of SOC 2, closing 5 critical findings.

BrightPath Solutions — Senior Infrastructure Engineer

2014-02 — 2018-12

- Improved cluster utilisation by 35% through right-sizing and Docker autoscaling policies.
- Cut container image sizes by 60%, shortening cold starts across the fleet.
- Automated 30 manual runbooks, saving an estimated 40 engineer-hours per month.

Site Reliability Engineer, Redwood Data

2008-03 — 2014-02

- Led the Kubernetes upgrade across 4 clusters with zero customer-visible downtime.
- Built observability on Linux so teams could self-serve dashboards instead of filing tickets.

Junior DevOps Engineer, Amazon

2004-11 — 2007-11

- Wrote the platform team's paved-road documentation, cutting onboarding from weeks to days.
- Ran the on-call rotation for 8 production services, sustaining 99.9% availability.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, Kotlin

Frameworks: NumPy, TensorFlow

Cloud & DevOps: Ansible, Docker, Jenkins, Prometheus, Grafana, Nginx, GitHub Actions, Linux

Data: Redis, Kafka

Analytics & Design: Excel

Testing & Tooling: Confluence

Personal Projects

Commute optimiser

Pulls transit APIs and suggests departure times, built on Linux.

Professional Certifications

Tableau Desktop Specialist — Tableau, 2023

TensorFlow Developer Certificate — Google, 2021

Selected Publications

"Sequence alignment heuristics for large genomes" - co-authored conference paper, 2005.

Honours & Awards

Engineering Excellence Award, 2019

Best Team Contribution, 2024